

THE PASSIVE VOICE - USE

Martti spoke English on his holiday in England last summer.
English is spoken all over the world.

The Active Voice

The first sentence is in the Active Voice. There is **a clear subject** = Martti.
The Active Voice expresses what **somebody does, did, has done, or had done**.

The Passive Voice

The second sentence is in the Passive Voice. There is **no clear subject** in the sentence telling us who performs the action.
The Passive Voice expresses, for example, what **is done, was done, has been done, or had been done** in general without naming the agent.

Study these sentences:

They are in the Passive Voice. Try to translate them into your own mother-tongue.

English is **spoken** all over the world.

Paper and pulp **are produced** in Finland.

This house **was built** last year.

Those cars **were made** in Japan last year.

Pilotage **has been suspended**.

The houses in this street **have been painted** every year.

The survivors **had been picked up** by helicopter when the Marina arrived at the scene of the accident.

Has the ship **been located**?

Were any distress messages **sent** from the ship?

What languages **are spoken** in this country?

This car **was not manufactured** in Japan.

NOTE 1: The Passive Voice includes the different tense forms.

NOTE 2: In questions the word order changes.

THE PASSIVE VOICE - FORMATION

To be + Past Participle of the main verb

The Passive Voice is formed with the auxiliary “to be” and the Past Participle of the main verb.

Past Participle= the third form of the irregular verbs / ending -ed of regular verbs.

Example: write wrote **written** call called **called**.

The Role of the “to be”

It is the form of the auxiliary “to be” that expresses the tense form of the Passive Voice.

Example: The game of football **has been played** for more than a hundred years.

What is the tense of the auxiliary? It is the Perfect Tense = **has been**.

Thus the sentence **tells us what has been done** for more than a hundred years.

Present	The ship is called MS Marina.
Past	The ship was called MS Marina.
Perfect	The ship has been called MS Marina.
Past Perfect	The ship had been called Marina.
Future	The ship will be called MS Marina.
Conditional	The ship would be called MS Marina.

THE USE OF OTHER AUXILIARIES

Pilotage **will be resumed** at 16 00 hours.

The area **must be searched** by helicopter.

Can this problem **be solved**?

These documents **should be given** to the authorities.

Whom **should** the papers **be given** to?

The auxiliaries **can, will, may, must, would, could, should** and **might** are sometimes used as additional auxiliaries in a Passive sentence.

NOTE: After these auxiliaries the form of the auxiliary "**to be**" is always simply **be**.